

Conceptual consideration of visual art (CWP)
Esther Hong



Ai Weiwei
Illumination
2019
Kemper Art Museum Lobby



Upon seeing Ai Wei Wei's piece, *Illumination* in 2019 in real life, I was shocked. Seeing it digitally, I imagined a piece that truly was digital, an image put into an app to pixelize it. I imagined the piece to be a digitally printed piece, completely unlike the almost 3D, tactile, and ginormous piece that it was truly. Online, it was flattened into pixels, whereas in real life, it comes out, gaining texture and thus weight as it matches us viewers in the 3D world. The piece is more layered, tangible, and visceral as I viewed it in my world. The composition seemed a lot more stark and central, where the colors came to life and the contrast between the warm oranges and the cool, dark blues came to life. In person, the work surrounded me and came to life, where the glow of light of the camera, the richness and texture of material, and the balance of composition engage not just your eyes but your body as you move around it, seeing the 3D legos pop up from the wall. A piece of art I would've brushed off as a pixelated digital piece was stark and alive in real life.

This piece inspired me to continue with my research idea, an idea where the art isn't just as it seems, but it's more tangible, easy to hold, feel, and therefore in the 3D world with the viewer. With my work being a brief for a book, the physicality beyond just art of the children's book is perfect. I also explored some preliminary research about non-rip, non-spill pages for the children's book, again catering to the viewer's *physical* experience when viewing art.